

CMI HTQ UNIT 554

Assessment Brief:

Personal and Professional Development • V1.0



KEY INFORMATION FOR LEARNERS

Overview of assessment tasks

Each task in this assessment brief has been developed to enable you to evidence achievement of the learning outcomes and Assessment Criteria for **CMI HTQ Unit 554: Personal and Professional Development**. Each of the Assessment Criteria must gain a pass outcome for you to successfully achieve the unit.

Preparation for the assessment

- Please read the **CMI HTQ Unit 554** specification thoroughly as only the content related to the achievement of the Assessment Criteria will be assessed.
- Research the topics being assessed. Suggested reading/web resources are provided in the **CMI HTQ Unit 554** specification. Your tutor may signpost you to relevant resources. Additionally, you may access excellent online resources at ManagementDirect <https://members.md.cmi.org.uk>
- Please read the definitions of the command verbs used in the Assessment Criteria (e.g. evaluate, discuss, analyse) at <https://www.managers.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/Command-Verb-Definitions.pdf>

Completing the assessment brief

- The assessment brief contains a series of tasks which are clearly referenced to the relevant Assessment Criteria.
- Refer to the Assessment Guidance Table at the end of the assessment brief which outlines the requirements for a Pass or Refer.
- Evidence for assessment must be presented in the Assessment Booklet or other suitable format.
- If work based evidence is used, such as plans or documentation (which has been referred to within the main text, it should be included in the 'Work Based Evidence' section in the Assessment Booklet.
- Appendices are not a requirement of this assessment brief. If appendices are included these will not be marked or moderated by CMI.
- Work based evidence, where included, must not exceed SIX (6) pages. All evidence should be combined within the Assessment Booklet.
- Any assessment templates that have been created to support this unit are located in the Assessment Booklet.
- The Assessment Booklet must be completed in a professional manner (for example applying business conventions for writing formal reports) and by using Microsoft Word, Rich Text Format or another compatible software programme.
- The Assessment Booklet must be saved as a word document (.doc or .docx) and not in a PDF format.
- An appropriate referencing system (such as Harvard Referencing) must be used to ensure the original source(s) of quotations or models can be verified. Please refer to Reference and Citations Study guide at <https://www.managers.org.uk/~media/Files/PDF/Study%20Support/References-and-Citations.pdf>
- Finally, you must complete and sign the Learner Statement of Authenticity (an electronic signature is accepted).

Learner support

For information regarding policies and procedures for assessment (for example reasonable adjustments, learner support, appeals, complaints, certification, confidentiality, plagiarism) you should contact your tutor or Centre manager and refer to the CMI Level 5 Diploma For Operational Managers syllabus.

ASSESSMENT BRIEF: HTQ UNIT 554 - PERSONAL AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Assessment brief **CMI HTQ Unit 554** has been designed to equip learners with understanding of the value of reflective practice, and enable them to evidence how reflection can be used as the basis of a meaningful and ongoing personal and professional development plan.

Being equipped with the knowledge, skills and behaviours to manage and lead in a variety of organisational settings is essential if an individual and their organisation are to succeed.

Reflective practice is an essential management tool which supports the development of knowledge, skills and behaviours in the workplace, and by consciously analysing your own performance, decision making, leadership and management skills, opportunities for on-going development can be identified.

ASSESSMENT TASKS AND WORD COUNT

Assessment brief **CMI HTQ Unit 554** features the following assessment tasks. Further detail is provided against each assessment task within the brief.

Assessment Task		Learning outcomes covered by assessment method	Assessment Criteria	L5 ODM KSB	Guideline word count
1	Write a briefing paper titled: <i>The use of reflective practice in personal and professional development</i>	LO1: Understand the value of reflective practice to inform personal and professional development	1.1 Analyse the importance of continuous personal and professional development in achieving organisational objectives	K17 B1 B4	Approx. 1500 words
			1.2 Evaluate the use of reflective practice in personal and professional development		
			1.3 Evaluate approaches to reflective practice		
2	Create a Reflective Account to inform own development	LO2: Be able to apply reflective practice to inform personal and professional development	2.1 Evaluate own performance in the workplace using principles of reflection	S19 S20 B1 B2 B3 B4 B5	Approx. 1000 words
			2.2 Reflect on own working style and its impact on others in the workplace		
3	Create a Personal Development Plan	LO3: Be able to create an informed personal development plan	3.1 Analyse development needs for current and future roles	S19 S20 B1 B2 B3 B4 B5	Approx. 1500 words
			3.2 Examine development opportunities to meet short, medium and long term objectives		
			3.3 Create a personal development plan with measurable objectives		

Guideline word count

The written word, whether generated and/or recorded, is expected to form the majority of assessable work produced by Learners at Level 5. The amount and volume of written work for this unit should be broadly comparable to a word count of **4000** words within a margin of +/-10%. The unit also includes additional work in the form of work based evidence. Excessive use of word count is not grounds for referral, however, the CMI reserves the right to return work to the Centre for editing and resubmission by the Learner.

The following are excluded from the written word count: Index or contents pages, headings and subheadings, diagrams, charts and graphs, bibliography.

If you require further guidance on assessment, please ask your centre to refer to [CMI's Quality Assurance Handbook](#).

THE VALUE OF REFLECTIVE PRACTICE TO INFORM PERSONAL AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Reflective practice is an essential management tool that supports the development of a manager's knowledge, skills and behaviours in the workplace and delivers benefits to both the individual and the organisation. Learning through doing and reflecting on the outcome of any activity is at the heart of continuous self-improvement and development.

Although it can often be difficult to find time to reflect, the process is an invaluable skill which if carried out with an open mind and a willingness to learn can reap benefits throughout an individual's career.

TASK 1

Write a **briefing paper** titled: '*The use of reflective practice in personal and professional development*'

The briefing paper should be in 3 parts:

1. **Analyse the importance of continuous personal and professional development in achieving organisational objectives** (AC1.1)
2. **Evaluate the use of reflective practice in personal and professional development** (AC1.2)
3. **Evaluate approaches used in reflective practice** (AC1.3)

Guidance for completion of Task 1

- *Your briefing paper should summarise the facts pertaining to a particular issue or problem, and should include a suggested course of action.*
- *Your briefing paper should include appropriate sub headings to organise the content clearly. You may choose to include tables and diagrams (as appropriate, but avoid over-reliance on these visual aids) that can be included to support your discussion. Ensure all tables and diagrams are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.*
- *Your discussion should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles and references to relevant models and frameworks.*
- *You may use well-chosen work-based examples from your own organisation or an organisation you have researched and are familiar with.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for the Assessment Criteria (AC) outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 1500 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.*

APPLYING REFLECTIVE PRACTICE TO INFORM PERSONAL AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Being able to reflect on your own capabilities and actions is a skill which may not come easily, but can be developed. As you progress reflection becomes an integral part of how you work and develop throughout your career.

TASK 2

Create a **Reflective Account** to inform your own development.

The **Reflective Account** must:

1. **Evaluate own performance in the workplace using principles of reflection (AC 2.1)**
2. **Reflect on own working style and its impact on others in the workplace (AC 2.2)**

Guidance for completion of Task 2 - Part 2

- *Your reflective account should describe your actions in a particular situation and reflect on the reasons for acting in that way.*
- *You may use well-chosen work-based examples from your own organisation or an organisation you have researched and are familiar with.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for the Assessment Criteria (AC) outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 1000 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.*

PERSONAL AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Professional development can help individuals hone existing skills and acquire new ones. Investing in your career development demonstrates commitment to personal and career growth. Having a Personal Development Plan helps you stay focused and motivated in achieving your personal goals.

TASK 3

Create a **Personal and Professional Development Plan** (AC 3.3).

Your **Personal and Professional Development Plan** must have a minimum of 3 (THREE) and maximum of 6 (SIX) measurable personal and professional objectives, including at least 1 (ONE) short term, 1 (ONE) medium term, and 1 (ONE) long term objective.

Your **Plan** needs to evidence:

- **Analyse your develop needs for current and future roles** (AC 3.1)
- **How you will do it** (AC 3.2)
- **What support and/or resources you will need** (AC 3.2)
- **Examine the type of development opportunities available that will help meet your objectives** (AC 3.2)
- **How you will know that this objective has been successful** (AC 3.3)
- **The target date for this objective to be achieved** (AC 3.3)

Guidance for completion of Task 3

- *The personal and professional development plan may be presented in a format of your choice, CMI template included in Assessment Booklet.*
- *Short term objectives are defined as something needing to be achieved within 4 to 6 weeks.*
- *Medium term objectives are defined as something needing to be achieved within 2 to 6 months.*
- *Long term objectives are defined as something needing to be achieved within 7 months or more from the start of the plan.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for the Assessment Criteria (AC) outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 1500 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.*

Refer	Pass
• Not all Assessment Criteria have been met • No examples were used or the examples given do not match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Unclear • Technically incorrect or inaccurate • Biassed • Includes unprofessional language • Poorly structured and presented • Lacks sufficient detail to show understanding of the topic • The application of different theories or approaches is incorrect, unclear or inappropriate • Evidence is not directly attributable to the learner • Evidence of plagiarism, collusion, cheating • External sources of information are not acknowledged • Work based evidence does not meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are not current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)	• All Assessment Criteria have been met • Examples given are well chosen and match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Well written and presented • Contains a breadth of examples • Accurate • Current • Authentic • Inclusive • Coherent • Credible • Technically correct • Evidence shows understanding of different theories or approaches, is clear and appropriate • Evidence used from external sources has been correctly cited and referenced • Evidence is directly attributable to the learner • Work based evidence does meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)